

it but like with everything else, it takes some getting used to. With time, it gets easier as you learn about the virtues of its introduction. Let's look at some of these benefits.

Goodbye modem. Hello Wi-Fi

It's mind-blowing how much progress we've made, especially in the fields of science and tech. Today's kids will never experience the frustration of 90s kids. We grew up around landline phones and desktop computers that would take forever to start. And don't even get us started on modems that would kick us out of chatrooms the moment the landline phone was picked up. Tech has taken great strides even in terms of how much processing power gadgets of today have. Try this on for size: You'd need approximately 850 old Apple computers to equal the power of a single iPhone – something that can fit in the palm of your hand.

Let the games begin

Researchers say that the brain is ever-changing and not fixed so interacting with a device may make your kid's brain sharper. It's common knowledge that playing action games improves hand-eye co-ordination, but did you know that gaming also aids in multi-tasking, decision making and self control? As per a study published in December 2013, there's "a robust positive association between cortical thickness and video gaming duration".

Furthermore, improvements in higher-level cognitive functions such as task switching, working memory and reasoning were associated with improvements in a strategic video game. This study was supported by an experiment led by Adam Chie-Ming Oei and Michael Donald Patterson at the Nanyang Technical University of Singapore. The duo studied different types of games – spanning life simulation games (e.g. Sims), object matching games (e.g. Bejeweled) and action games/finding hidden objects (e.g. Hidden Expedition) – and their positive impacts on different types of cognitive skills. The researchers identified an improvement in visual search skills, which were sharpened through games that required matching and spatial memory capabilities. Also, the ability to track multiple objects improved via action games. Soon, we'll be seeing games being prescribed for clinical treatments of ADHD or even brain injuries. If the game is well designed enough, its benefits can surpass even the advantages of reading books and consuming other forms of media.